



ADJECTIVES

The words that describe nouns

1 What is it?

Adjectives (AJ-ik-tivz)

An adjective is a word that describes or gives more information about a noun — telling us what kind, which one, or how many.

describes + a noun

2 See it in action

What kind

"The **tall, mysterious** stranger walked in."

Which one

"Pass me **that** book, not **this** one."

How many

"There were **seven** empty seats left."

Feeling

"It was a **terrifying** and **exhausting** night."



Look here!

Try removing every adjective from a paragraph, then read it back — you'll see exactly how much detail they were adding.

3 More to know

Whose

"That is **my** jacket, not **your** one."

Comparative

"This bag is **heavier** than that one, but the **heaviest** is over there."

FUN FACT

In English, adjectives before a noun follow a hidden order native speakers use without thinking — opinion, size, age, shape, colour, origin, material, purpose ("a lovely little old round French wooden dining table").

4 Why it's used

Adjectives help: paint a clearer picture for the reader — they turn a flat sentence into something vivid and specific.

Adjectives usually sit right before the noun they describe ("the dark forest") but can also follow a being verb ("the forest was dark").



Good spot!

Ask yourself: what kind, which one, or how many? If a word answers one of those about a noun, it's an adjective.

5 Where you'll spot it

Before the noun

Most common position: "a bright light", "an old house".

After a being verb

Also common: "the light was bright", "the house seemed old".

⚠ Watch out!

Don't overload a sentence with too many adjectives at once — one or two well-chosen ones (like "terrifying") are usually more powerful than a long list.

6 Quick recap

Describes a noun

Tells kind/which/how many

Sits before or after the noun



Quick reminder!

Two or three carefully chosen adjectives usually beat five generic ones — quality over quantity.